

Igor B. Martins

Researcher in Economic History, Lund University



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Malmö, Sweden

Academic Experience

2024–

Researcher

Lund University Sweden

2022–2023

Postdoctoral Research Associate

University of Cambridge United Kingdom

2020–2023

Postdoctoral Fellow

Lund University Sweden

2017–2018

Visiting Researcher

Stellenbosch University South Africa

Education

2016–2020

Ph.D., Economic History

Lund University Sweden

2014–2016

M.Sc., Economic History

Lund University Sweden

2008–2011

B.Sc., Economics

Fundação Getulio Vargas Brazil

Published works

- **Martins, I.** (forthcoming). Living Standards in Ghana, 1955–2005, in G. Austin, A. Britwum, L. Doumbia, A. Eckert, & N.Y. Spong (eds), *Labour and Work in Ghana Since Independence*, London: Bloomsbury Academic.
- **Martins, I.**, & Green, E. (forthcoming). Från arbetskraft till kapital: Slaveriets ekonomiska logik i globalt perspektiv, *Statsvetenskaplig tidskrift*.
- **Martins, I.** (2026). Capital and Coercion: Slavery after the 1807 import ban in the Cape Colony, *European Review of Economic History*, heag012.
- **Martins, I.**, & Green, E. (2025). Theoretical Foundations of the Economics of Slavery: Enslaved people as capital investments in the Atlantic world, *Journal of Global History*, vol. 21, no. 1, pp.22–40.
- **Martins, I.** (2025). Is the Business of Conquest the Conquest of Business?, *The Case Centre*, 225-0045-1.

- Cilliers, J., Mariotti, M., & **Martins, I.** (2024). Fertility Responses to Short-Term Economic Stress: Price volatility and wealth shocks in a pre-transitional settler colony, *Explorations in Economic History*, 101620.
- Smythe, A., **Martins, I.**, & Andersson, M. (2024). Inequality, Poverty, and Economic Shrinking: How can developing countries build greater resilience for more sustainable development patterns?, *International Journal of Development Issues*, vol. 23, no. 1, pp.40–81.
- **Martins, I.**, & Schwaag Serger, S. (2023). An Age of Disentangled Research?, *Issues in Science and Technology*, vol. 40, no. 1, pp.38–43.
- **Martins, I.**, & Schwaag Serger, S. (2023). *Shifting Patterns in International Research Cooperation*, Stockholm: STINT.
- Axelsson, T., & **Martins, I.** (2023). Resilience to Shrinking as a Catch-up Strategy: A comparison of Brazil and Indonesia, 1964–2019, *Studies in Comparative International Development*, vol. 59, no. 3, pp.491–516.
- **Martins, I.**, Cilliers, J., & Fourie, J. (2022). Legacies of Loss: The health outcomes of slaveholder compensation in the British Cape Colony, *Explorations in Economic History*, 101506.
- **Martins, I.** (2020). Collateral Effect: Slavery and wealth in the Cape Colony, PhD thesis, Department of Economic History, Lund University.
- Palacio, A., & **Martins, I.** (2019). What Caused Poverty Reduction in Brazil During the 2000s: Sectoral growth or public expenditures, *OASIS. Observatorio de Analisis de los Sistemas Internacionales*, vol. 32, pp.1–25.
- Palacio, A., & **Martins, I.** (2018). Poverty and Democracy: The Brazilian experience, in D. Rauhut & N. Hatti (eds), *Poverty, Politics and the Poverty of Politics*, New Delhi: B.R. Publishing Corporation, pp.193–210.

Works under review

- **Martins, I.** (2026). Art, Craft, and the Case for Artisanal Doctoral Supervision in the Humanities, *Studies in Higher Education*. Revise & Resubmit.
- **Martins, I.** (2026). Retrieval-Restricted Reasoning: A Proof of Concept for Adapting Language Models to Economic History, *Historical Methods: A Journal of Quantitative and Interdisciplinary History*. Revise & Resubmit.
- **Martins, I.** (2026). Slave Emancipation and Agricultural Output in the Cape Colony, *Cliometrica*. Submitted.
- Makuei, J., & **Martins, I.** (2026). Democracy and Rural Inequality in Kenya, 1997–2010, *African Affairs*. Submitted.
- **Martins, I.**, Grab, S., & Green, E. (2026). Asset ownership turns climate exposure into inequality, *Nature Communications*. Revise & Resubmit.

Work in progress

- **Martins, I.**, Schoots, J., & Green, E. Held by the Elite: Monopoly Rights and Dynastic Persistence at the Cape Colony, 1680–1794.
- Smythe, A., & **Martins, I.** Resilience and Growth Theory: A novel conceptualisation of convergence.
- Cilliers, J., & **Martins, I.** Malthus at the Cape: Wealth, status, and mortality in a pre-industrial settler society.
- Cilliers, J., & **Martins, I.** Forebearers: The forgotten women of the Cape Colony.
- **Martins, I.**, & Green, E. What Are Institutions Made Of? A social contract approach.
- **Martins, I.**, Aboagye, P., & Austin, G. The Ghanaian Divergence: Prices, incomes and living standards after independence.

External funding

2027–2029

Handelsbanken Research Foundations

Flying Blind: Tsetse Ecology, Colonial Response and Long-Run Health in Southeast Africa (P26-0357) Project researcher. Engaged at 30% for three years.
SEK 1,500,000 ($\approx$ EUR 138,500 / USD 163,000)

2024–2027

Vetenskapsrådet

Causes and Consequences of Long-Term Inequality: Africa's Levels and Trends (2023-00809_VR) Project researcher. Engaged at 20% for two years.
SEK 6,737,000 ($\approx$ EUR 623,623 / USD 735,688)

2022–2026

Handelsbanken Research Foundations

Resilience to Economic Shrinking: The Role of Autonomous Financial Systems (P21-0044) Project researcher. Engaged at approx. 30% for two years.
SEK 1,725,000 ($\approx$ EUR 150,000 / USD 164,000)

2022–2025

Arts and Humanities Research Council (UK)

Where have all the Workers Gone? Labour and Work in Ghana, 1951–2010 (AH/W010852/1) Postdoctoral Research Associate. Engaged at 100% for one year.
SEK 3,332,000 ($\approx$ EUR 308,438 / GBP 268,859)

2021–2026

Riksbankens Jubileumsfond

The establishment, growth and legacy of a settler colony: Quantitative panel studies of the political economy of the Cape Colony (M20-0041) Project researcher. Engaged at 40% for four years (2021–2024) and 20% for two years (2025–2026).
SEK 29,000,000 ($\approx$ EUR 2,520,000 / USD 2,760,000)

2017–2018

Erasmus Mundus Action 2 Programme (INSPIRE)

Scholarship Stellenbosch University, South Africa
Supported research training on the economic history of the Cape Colony.
SEK 157,000

Pending PI applications (submitted 2025–2026)

2026–

Vetenskapsrådet (VR)

TIES (Theory of Institutions as Embedded Social Contracts) Principal Investigator
SEK 6,632,892

Teaching experience

2025–

Development in a Historical Perspective - Economic, Social and Political Transformation

Lund University Course convener

2023–2026

Growth, Stagnation, and Inequality in Africa

Lund University Course convener

2019–2026

The Art of Writing and Reporting

Lund University Course convener

2019–

Colonialism and Economic Change in Africa, Asia and Latin America

Lund University Lecturer

2019–2026

Field Work/Internship and Research Overview

Lund University Course convener

Pedagogical qualifications

2026–

Teaching portfolio

The Joint Faculties of Humanities and Theology Lund University, Sweden

2025

Course design in higher education

The Joint Faculties of Humanities and Theology Lund University, Sweden

2024

Doctoral supervision

The Joint Faculties of Humanities and Theology Lund University, Sweden

2022

Teaching and learning in higher education II

The Joint Faculties of Humanities and Theology Lund University, Sweden

2021

Teaching and learning in higher education I

The Joint Faculties of Humanities and Theology Lund University, Sweden

2020

How to teach with cases

Lund University School of Economics and Management Lund University, Sweden

2019

How to write cases

Lund University School of Economics and Management Lund University, Sweden

Supervision

2023–2026

Doctoral

Benjamin Chatterton, PhD in Economic History Lund University

Co-supervisor

Expected completion November 2026

2021–

Master's

11 theses in Economic History Lund University

2019–

Bachelor's

7 theses in Economic History Lund University

Awards

2020

Teacher of the Year

Lund University School of Economics and Management

Media Outreach

- **Martins, I.** (2026). Assessing students' academic writing when AI can produce a first draft, *Times Higher Education*.
- **Martins, I.** (2026). Portuguese Sources and the Shape of an Angolan Social Table, *African Long-Term Inequality Trends (AFLIT)*.
- **Martins, I.** (2026). Capital and Coercion: Why Slavery Persisted after Britain Banned the Trade, *European Historical Economics Society*.
- **Martins, I.** (2026). Theoretical Foundations of the Economics of Slavery: Enslaved people as capital investments in the Atlantic world, *Frontiers in African Economic History Blog*.
- **Martins, I.** (2025). Devo, não nego, pago com o meu escravo - Como pessoas escravizadas viravam garantia de crédito, *The Conversation Brasil*.
- **Martins, I.** (2025). What Is Economic History?, *Tell Me About* [podcast].
- **Martins, I.** (2025). Students Learn Best When They're Not Handed a Map: 4 steps to structure discomfort in your case classroom, *Inspiring Minds*.
- **Martins, I.** (2025). The Pressure to Quantify Research Is Erasing Conceptual Depth, *LSE Impact Blog*.
- Kim, H., Schwaag Serger, S., Mobrand, E., & **Martins, I.** (2024). International Science Is Having a Messy Breakup, *Research Professional News*.
- **Martins, I.** (2023). Does a Negative Wealth Shock Affect Your Health? Evidence from an episode of 'Expropriation with Partial Compensation' in nineteenth-century South Africa, *Our Long Walk: Reflections on South Africa, from an Economic History Perspective*.
- **Martins, I.** (2023). Legacies of Loss: The health outcomes of slaveholder compensation in the British Cape Colony, *Frontiers in African Economic History Blog*.

Editorial and Review Experience

2026–	Peer-reviewer Studies in Higher Education
2025	Peer-reviewer International Journal of Development Issues
2025	Peer-reviewer Asia-Pacific Economic History Review
2024	Peer-reviewer Studies in Comparative International Development
2023	Peer-reviewer Technological Forecasting and Social Change

Service

2025–2026	United Nations Development Programme Consultant Commissioned by the UNDP's Strategy, Policy and Capacities for Economic Management (SPACE) Unit of South Sudan as a consultant to the country's first Multidimensional Poverty Index (MPI) report.
2023–	Swedish Economic History Association Auditor The SEHA promotes the spread of knowledge about economic and social history, as well as historical and geographical research. The association organises lectures and conferences.
2017–	Laboratory for the Economics of Africa's Past Stellenbosch University Visiting Researcher The Laboratory for the Economics of Africa's Past is dedicated to the quantitative study of African economic and social history.
2023–2025	World Economic History Congress 2025 Lund, Sweden Conference Manager Co-organised the 19th WEHC, a major international conference in economic history with over 1,200 participants. Contributed to programme coordination, hybrid participation logistics, volunteer management, statistical reporting, and post-conference analysis. Oversaw technical workflows, communication, and strategic structuring of the scientific and cultural programme.
2023–2024	The Swedish Foundation for International Cooperation in Research and Higher Education (STINT) Consultant STINT supports internationalisation in Swedish higher education by funding initiatives led by researchers, educators, and academic leaders.

2022–2023

Clare Hall Affiliated Postdoctoral Member

Clare Hall is a constituent college of the University of Cambridge established to serve as an Institute of Advanced Studies.

2021–2023

Swedish Economic History Association

Treasurer

2019–2020

Ekonomisk Doktorandrådet (EDR)

Lund University

President

EDR functions as a platform for communication, driving the matters of doctoral students at LUSEM and ensuring the representation of doctoral students at faculty levels.

2018–2019

Ekonomisk Doktorandrådet (EDR)

Lund University

Vice-President

2018–2020

The Economic History Society

University of Glasgow

Student Ambassador

EHS Student Ambassadors facilitate communication between the Economic History Society and students interested in economic and/or social history.

Professional memberships

Economic History Association, Economic History Society, Social Science History Association, African Economic History Network, Swedish Economic History Association

Recent conferences, workshops and seminars

02/2026

Trelleborgs Biblioteket

Trelleborg, Sweden **Speaker**

How did colonial institutions shape African democracy and development?

07/2025

World Economic History Congress

Lund, Sweden **Organiser & Panellist**

The geography of development in Portuguese Africa: Lessons from Angola

12/2024

African Studies Association

Chicago, USA **Panellist**

Market Integration and the Development of Capitalism in Ghana, 1987–2005

12/2023

Utbildningsdepartementet

Stockholm, Sweden **Panellist**

Shifting patterns in international research collaboration

09/2023

Seminarium om förändrade mönster för internationella forskningssamarbeten

Stockholm, Sweden **Panellist**

Shifting patterns in international research collaboration

09/2023

Swedish Economic History meeting

Lund, Sweden **Organizer & Panellist**

Resilience and Growth Theory: A novel conceptualisation of convergence

03/2023

African Economic History SeminarCambridge, United Kingdom **Panellist**

Raising capital to raise crops: Slave emancipation and agricultural output in the Cape Colony

Selected earlier conferences (2017–2022)

07/2022

World Economic History CongressParis, France **Panellist**

07/2018

World Economic History CongressBoston, USA **Panellist**

10/2022

African Economic History Network annual meetingTenerife, Spain **Panellist**

10/2018

African Economic History Network annual meetingBologna, Italy **Panellist**

10/2017

African Economic History Network annual meetingStellenbosch, South Africa **Panellist**

04/2018

European Social Science History ConferenceBelfast, UK **Panellist**

01/2019

Allied Social Sciences AssociationAtlanta, USA **Panellist**

10/2021

Swedish Economic History meetingGothenburg, Sweden **Panellist**

10/2019

Swedish Economic History meetingUppsala, Sweden **Panellist****Administrative reference****Prof. Mats Olsson**

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Academic references**Prof. Erik Green**

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Prof. Anne McCants

MIT, USA

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Prof. Gareth Austin

University of Cambridge, UK

gma31@cam.ac.uk

Prof. Jeanne Cilliers

Linköping University, Sweden

jeanne.cilliers@liu.se

Teaching references**Dr. Tobias Axelsson**

Lund University, Sweden

tobias.axelsson@ekh.lu.se

Assoc. Prof. Tobias Karlsson

Lund University, Sweden

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